

A SAMPLE LESSON

The Façade

BOOK FOUR · GRADES 9–10

Unit 1 · Lesson 1 — “Beyond the Brand”

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CURRICULUM

The Architecture of Grace Foundation

Beyond the Brand

45–50 min · August Week 1 · First lesson of the year

■ PPRA · COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

PPRA-designated: psychological self-examination — students examine the gap between public persona and private self. Advance parental notification required (min. 10 days). Standard 3-tier opt-out protocols apply. Brief counselor at least 2 days before delivery. Never ask students to share their curated-vs-authentic gap with the whole class — journal first, always.

OBJECTIVE	Students explain the gap between the curated persona and the authentic self, and identify one specific cost they personally pay to maintain a curated performance.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting).
VOCABULARY	curated self · authentic self · performance tax · persona · gap · integrity · self-monitoring
MATERIALS	Student journals · anchor chart paper · markers · Scenario Cards B4-1A & B4-1B

ANCHOR CHART · THE PERFORMANCE TAX

Curated Self — filtered, selected, performed for an audience: what you show. **Authentic Self** — unfiltered, private, costly to reveal: what is actually true. **Performance Tax = Gap Width × Time Maintained.**

OPENING RITUAL · 3 MIN

“Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.” [Pause 10 seconds. Do not fill it.] Post the essential question: *“Who are you when no one is watching?”* *“That is the question this unit is built around. Today we start looking at that gap — and what it costs to maintain it.”*

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1–3

1

The Curated Self — Name the Gap

10 MIN

“Look at your profile photo or most recent public post. Is the person in that image the same person who woke up this morning?” Take 2–3 responses. *“We all manage how we appear. That is not dishonesty — that is being human. The question is: what is it costing you?”* This curriculum calls that cost the Performance Tax.

2

The Performance Tax — How It Works

8 MIN

Write on the board: **TAX = GAP × TIME.** *“Psychologists call the mechanism self-monitoring — the cognitive effort of continuously tracking how you appear. It runs on the same working memory you use for everything else that matters.”* Students journal 3 minutes, privately: where am I spending the most performance energy right now? Do not ask for sharing.

3

Is the Gap Worth It? 7 MIN

"Not all curation is a problem. The question is not whether you adjust your presentation — you do, and so does everyone. The question is whether the gap is costing you more than it is giving you." Write the signal question on the board. Students write privately: "One thing my curated self shows that my authentic self doesn't fully believe is ____." Private. Not shared.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Observe: during the journal prompt, a student who writes immediately, intensely, and at length. **May signal:** a large, established gap — relief at having language for it, or activation at naming it; a well-rehearsed gap at 9–10 often carries shame underneath. **Action:** note privately; flag for counselor awareness before the U2 Backpack Audit.

GRADES 9–10

Keep the gap concept concrete and scenario-grounded. The essential question is planted today — it does not need to be answered today.

GRADES 11–12

The gap has typically been maintained for years; the Performance Tax is higher. Push further: "What has the sustained performance cost you in relationships where you actually wanted to be known?"

SCENARIO CARD B4-1A • "BEYOND THE BRAND"

Kameron runs a school account with 2,300 followers — perfectly lit, witty, effortlessly social. At home he is often anxious and lonely. His oldest friend says, "It's all technically true, but it doesn't feel like you." *Can something be factually accurate and still misrepresent you?*

EXIT TICKET • JOURNAL (NEVER COLLECTED, NEVER GRADED)

"The gap between my curated self and my authentic self right now is _____. The performance tax I pay shows up as _____. One thing I'd have more of if the gap were smaller is _____."

FAMILY CONNECTION • CONVERSATION STARTER (PPRA LESSON)

No student was asked to disclose personal information; all reflection was private and journal-based. A starter that might open this naturally: "Is there a version of you that people see that feels different from how you actually are inside?" The fact that you asked it — and meant it — is enough.

THIS LESSON INCLUDES

Anchor Chart

Scenario Cards B4-1A / B4-1B

Journal Prompts

END OF THE SAMPLE LESSON

Who are you when no one is watching?

The Façade • Book Four of The Architecture of Grace • Grades 9–10